

Where does information in a science article in a newspaper/news website/social media come from?

- Generally, news organizations do not conduct their primary research
- Journalists and scientists look for catchy headlines
- Research is typically conducted at university, hospitals and government institutions, private facilities, and non-governmental organizations aka NGO's (ex. Charities, non-profits)
- Research is generally shared with a broad audience through peer-reviewed publications

Spotting Fake News: (not in order of importance)

1. Consider the source: is there an author? What are their credentials on relevant issues?
2. Read beyond: headlines can be outrageous in an effort to get clicks
3. Supporting sources: click on links/check with official sources. Do they support the story?
4. Do others agree?: Are any other sites reporting this? What sources are they citing?
5. Is it a joke?: If it is too outlandish, it might be satire. Research sources
6. Check your biases" consider if your own beliefs or concerns could affect your judgment
7. Ask the experts: ask a librarian/consult a fact-checking site, official sources like the WHO (World Health Organization)

Peer Review:

- Can go back and forth many times between researchers/editors/peer reviewers
- Not perfect, but when done with good intention by experts does a reasonable job of detecting problems
- Retractions and corrections do happen

How to tell if a source is peer-reviewed:

- Go to source home page, read 'about'/'for authors'
- Search peer view, ensure result is from a trustworthy source (journal's website)
- **Pay attention to document type:** some peer-reviewed journals contain summaries/commentary/opinion pieces/summaries/new articles that are often not peer-reviewed